

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

Purchased:

-----X
STEVEN RODRIGUEZ,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, DAVID VARDZEL, KEITH
YEUNG, CHARLES GUEVARRA, VINROY AMBERSLY,
PATRICIA SOTO, KENNETH MUNOZ, and JOHN OR
JANE DOE 1-10,

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff designates New York County
as the place of trial

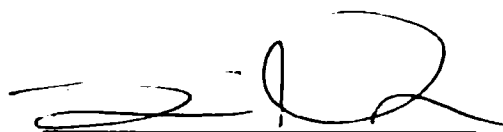
The basis of the venue is where the
injury occurred

SUMMONS

TO THE ABOVE-NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bayside, New York
April 1, 2021



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JANE DOE 1-10,

The basis of the venue is where the
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VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff, Steven Rodriguez, by and through the undersigned attorneys, Sim & DePaola, LLP, for his complaint against the Defendants, City of New York, DAVID VARDZEL, KEITH YEUNG, CHARLES GUEVARRA, VINROY AMBERSLY, PATRICIA SOTO, KENNETH MUNOZ, and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, individually and officially in their capacities as New York City police officers, alleges and states as follows:

1. This is a civil rights action, in which Plaintiff seeks relief, vis-à-vis 42 U.S.C. §§ 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988, the laws of the State of New York, in addition to the self-executing clauses or implied private causes of action within the New York State Constitution, for the violations of her civil rights, as guaranteed and protected by the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, as well as the Laws and Constitution of the State of New York.
2. These claims arise from a September 1, 2018 incident in which Defendants, including DAVID VARDZEL, KEITH YEUNG, CHARLES GUEVARRA, VINROY AMBERSLY, PATRICIA SOTO, KENNETH MUNOZ and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, acting under color of state law, unlawfully stopped, arrested and detained Mr. Rodriguez without a valid warrant, reasonable suspicion or probable cause to do so. Mr. Rodriguez was subsequently charged with

one (1) count of Sexual Abuse in the first degree, one (1) count of Forcible Touching and one (1) count of Endangering the Welfare of a Child. As a result, Mr. Rodriguez was wrongfully incarcerated at Riker's Island for approximately one (1) year and twelve (12) days. He was thereafter maliciously prosecuted, until all charges was dismissed at trial on September 13, 2019 which constituted a termination of the criminal proceedings in favor of the accused.

3. The above referenced acts caused Mr. Rodriguez to be deprived of his liberty, denied the due process of the laws and to sustain various emotional and physical injuries.

4. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against Defendants, as well as an award of costs and attorneys' fees, and such other and further relief as the Court may deem just and proper.

JURISDICTION

5. This action arises under the Fourth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, under 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988 and pursuant to the Laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

6. The jurisdiction of this Court is predicated upon 28 U.S.C. §§ 1331, 1343(a)(3) and (4), 1367(a) and the doctrine of supplemental jurisdiction.

PARTIES

7. Plaintiff, Steven Rodriguez ("Mr. Rodriguez"), is an adult Hispanic male, who resides in New York County, within the City and State of New York.

8. The Defendant, City of New York ("City"), is a municipal corporation duly organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York.

9. At all relevant times herein, the New York City Police Department (“NYPD”) was a wholly owned subsidiary which was further wholly operated, managed, maintained, and controlled by Defendant City.

10. At all relevant times herein, Defendant City, acting through the New York City Police Department (“NYPD”), was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers, detectives, and supervisory officers as well as the individually named Defendants herein.

11. At all relevant times herein, Defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and the State of New York.

12. At all relevant times herein, Defendant, DAVID VARDZEL (“VARDZEL”), Shield # 2793, Tax No. 965590, was a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such were acting in the capacity of agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant VARDZEL was, believed to be assigned to the Transit Division District 4, Union Sq Subway Station, 14th St/Union Sq West, New York, NY 10003. Defendant VARDZEL is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

13. At all relevant times herein, Defendant, KEITH YOUNG (“YOUNG”), Shield # 29035, Tax No. 958182, was a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such were acting in the capacity of agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant YOUNG was, believed to be assigned to the Transit Division District 3, W 145th Street and St. Nicholas Ave Subway Station, New York, NY 10019. Defendant YOUNG is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

14. At all relevant times herein, Defendant, CHARLES GUEVARRA (“GUEVARRA”), Shield # 9774, Tax No. 960628, was a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such were acting in the capacity of agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant GUEVARRA was, believed to be assigned to the Transit Division District 20, Briarwood Subway Station, 13702 Queens Blvd, Briarwood, Queens 11435. Defendant GUEVARRA is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

15. At all relevant times herein, Defendant, VINROY AMBERSLEY (“AMBERSLEY”), Tax No. 911204, was a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such were acting in the capacity of agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant AMBERSLEY is, believed to be retired. Defendant AMBERSLEY is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

16. At all relevant times herein, Defendant, PATRICIA SOTO (“SOTO”), Shield # 2793, Tax No. 965544, was a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such were acting in the capacity of agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant SOTO was, believed to be assigned to the Transit Division District 4, Union Sq Subway Station, 14th St/Union Sq West, New York, NY 10003. Defendant SOTO is being sued in her individual and official capacities.

17. At all times relevant here in, Defendant, KENNETH MUNOZ (“MUNOZ”), Shield # 18791, Tax No. 961967, was a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such were acting in the capacity of agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant MUNOZ was, believed to be assigned to the Transit Division District 4, Union Sq Subway Station, 14th St/Union Sq West, New York, NY 10003. Defendant MUNOZ is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

18. At all relevant times, Defendants JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10 were police officers, detectives, supervisors, policy makers and/or officials employed by the NYPD. At this time, Plaintiff does not know the true names or tax registry numbers of JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, but believes such knowledge is within possession of the Defendants.

19. At all relevant times herein, Defendants JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10 were acting as agents, servants and employees of the City of New York, the NYPD. Defendants JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

20. At all relevant times herein, Defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York.

21. Plaintiff has filed a timely Notice of Claim on or about November 4, 2019.

FACTUAL CHARGES

22. On September 1, 2018, at approximately 8:13 p.m., Mr. Rodriguez was walking towards the exit of the subway station at Lexington Avenue and East 125th Street, County of New York, City and State of New York.

23. At the above stated location, Mr. Rodriguez was illegally stopped by Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, as he had not committed any crimes or violated any other laws.

24. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, approached Mr. Rodriguez without any legal basis or justification for doing so, as there were no indicia of criminal activity present due to exculpatory evidence that demonstrated Plaintiff's innocence.

25. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, then proceeded to illegally search Mr. Rodriguez's person, as Mr. Rodriguez had not committed any crimes and there was no credible evidence of sexual abuse, forcible touching or the endangerment of the welfare of a child.

26. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, falsely claimed that Plaintiff had sexually abused, forcible touched and endangered the welfare of a child.

27. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, were advised by the complaining witness that they nor anyone had observed Plaintiff commit any criminal acts.

28. Subsequent to Defendants' illegal searches of Mr. Rodriguez's person, Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, proceeded to illegally arrest Mr. Rodriguez for one (1) count of Sexual Abuse in the first degree, one (1) count of Forcible Touching and one (1) count of Endangering the Welfare of a Child based on their fabricated observations and claims.

29. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, slammed Mr. Rodriguez into a wall and applied the handcuffs to Mr. Rodriguez's person in an excessively forceful and tight fashion, which caused him to suffer substantial pain and discomfort.

30. Defendant VARDZEL signed an accusatory instrument, in which he swore to what he knew to be false and unsubstantiated allegations against Plaintiff.

31. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, knowingly and intentionally gave false, misleading, or incomplete information to the

District Attorney's Office, namely that he had committed sexual abuse, forcible touching and endangering the welfare of a child, so that a criminal prosecution would be initiated against Mr. Rodriguez.

32. Mr. Rodriguez asserts that Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, arrested and detained him with the full knowledge that he committed no crimes or violations of the law.

33. Mr. Rodriguez, therefore, asserts that due to the clear absence of any viable probable cause to warrant his detention or prosecution, at any point, he was unlawfully detained and maliciously prosecuted from the moment Defendants approached him, up to, and until the unconditional dismissal of the criminal charges against him on September 13, 2019.

34. Mr. Rodriguez was deprived of his liberty and freedom of movement for one (1) year and twelve (12) days until he was released on September 13, 2019, after his trial, because he was compelled to personally appear in court to contest the baseless allegations against him.

35. While Plaintiff was incarcerated, he was subjected to countless civil rights violations, gratuitous assaults and batteries, searches, strip searches, and all the attendant indignities attributable to wrongful incarceration.

36. These gratuitous infringements upon his liberty persisted until the New York County District Court moved to dismiss the criminal proceeding against Mr. Rodriguez on September 13, 2019 with a not guilty verdict at trial, representing a favorable termination.

37. At all times relevant hereto, the Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, were involved in the decision to arrest Plaintiff without probable cause, or failed to intervene when they observed others arresting Plaintiff without probable cause.

38. Defendant City has engaged in a policy, custom, or pattern and practice of searching and arresting ethnic minorities without probable cause or reasonable suspicion to do so.

39. Defendant City has also engaged in a policy, custom, or pattern and practice of illegally searching unlawfully individuals without any justification to do so, with the hope that said search will thereafter justify the illegal seizure.

40. Mr. Rodriguez asserts that the aforementioned unlawful acts committed by Defendants are representative of a pervasive policy, custom or pattern and practice within the City of New York and the NYPD.

41. Mr. Rodriguez asserts that Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, illegally searched his person, and then falsely arrested him, due solely to their racially discriminatory prejudices, their desire to meet an arrest quota and to benefit from increased overtime compensation.

42. Mr. Rodriguez further asserts that Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, acted in such an unlawfully reprehensible manner, due to their assumption that Defendants' version of events would undoubtedly and unduly be credited over Mr. Rodriguez's, solely because Mr. Rodriguez is a Hispanic male.

43. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, arrested and maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff, not because of any actual probable cause to believe Plaintiff had committed any crimes or violations of the law, but because of their pernicious belief that an individual like Plaintiff must be doing something illegal.

44. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, perpetrated multiple overt acts in furtherance of their obviously discriminatory

inclinations, namely the unlawful entrance, searches, assaults, batteries, seizure, arrest, and malicious prosecution against Plaintiff.

45. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, seized, arrested, and maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff, due solely to Defendants' perception or consideration of Plaintiff's race.

46. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, possessed no valid reason or probable cause to stop Plaintiff's person, to search Plaintiff's person, or to arrest Plaintiff, which gives rise to the strong inference that their unlawful conduct towards Plaintiff was discriminatorily motivated and enacted upon.

47. Defendants, including VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, subjected Plaintiff to disparate treatment compared to other individuals similarly situated, because Defendants did not stop any white individuals, who were actually committing crimes in the Defendants' view.

48. Plaintiff asserts that the Defendants, including VARDZEL, who violated Plaintiff's civil rights, are part of a larger pattern and practice of similar misconduct, which is so widespread, pervasive and consistent throughout the NYPD and the City of New York that the commission such constitutionally violative behavior has become tantamount to an official policy or custom within the NYPD and City of New York or, at the very least, conclusive evidence that the City and the NYPD have either tacitly approved of such egregious wrongdoings or that they have become deliberately indifferent to the civil rights of those who may come into contact their police officers.

49. The individually named Defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employ of the NYPD and City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently and

repeatedly engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and Constitution of the State of New York, all without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD, the City of New York and their respective policymakers and supervisors.

50. *The New York Times*, as well as numerous other reputable journalistic enterprises, have reported on the widespread corruption within the NYPD and City of New York, particularly the incredibly disconcerting proclivity of many NYPD officers to lie about subject matters that are materially relevant to criminal prosecutions, including the complete fabrication of arrest evidence and witnesses. Attached hereto, as Exhibit A, and incorporated by reference herein, are various articles and reports detailing the magnitude and overwhelming prevalence of incidents, in which NYPD officers were caught lying, including instances that resulted in the arrest and imprisonment of innocent people. Also detailed, is the NYPD's obstinate refusal to effectuate corrective or preventive measures to combat the inevitable recurrence of such misdeeds, and perhaps most troubling, the NYPD's alarming tendency to, instead, reward and promote these officers, including those who were inculcated via some incontrovertible form of evidence.

51. On March 18, 2018, *The New York Times* published an explosive article, entitled "Promotions, Not Punishments for Officers Accused of Lying," written by Joseph Goldstein. Mr. Goldstein shines a light on the multitude of flaws within the CCRB and the NYPD, highlighting the fact that the substantiation of a claim against an officer will invariably rely on the presence of incontrovertible proof against the officer. Due to the rarity availability of this type of evidence, an alarmingly small percentage of officer misconduct claims are substantiated. The CCRB is further handicapped by a terribly designed system that requires evidence of a virtually

indisputable nature to substantiate any claim against an officer. The article also details the NYPD's persistent reluctance to investigate or discipline officers who lie and even posits that this reluctance is a significant cause of the lying pandemic within the NYPD. The article references various officers and detectives who were the subject of credible accusations relating to the officers' intentionally false statements, with some allegations coming from federal and state judges.

52. On September 12, 2019, *The New York Times* published another article by Joseph Goldstein, entitled "Officers Said They Smelled Pot. The Judge Called Them Liars." Unsurprisingly, this article dealt with the unusually high frequency of officers using the odor of marijuana to excuse a search that conspicuously does not result in the recovery of any marijuana. It should not require an article in *The New York Times* to call attention to such patently disingenuous tactics, but has become necessary for a variety of reasons, including the NYPD's failure to correct such behavior, the willingness of prosecutors and judges to credit the lying officers and the increasing rate of occurrence.

53. On April 24, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled "Detective's Lies Sent Three People to Prison, Prosecutors Charge," by Sean Piccolo, detailing the lies of NYPD Second Grade Detective Joseph Franco and how those lies resulted in the imprisonment of at least three innocent people. The article described how Det. Franco lied about observing drug transactions on at least three separate occasions, lies that were only uncovered through contradictory video evidence. Det. Franco's lies resulted in the innocent individuals each being sentenced to prison terms in excess of one-year.

54. Other articles include: (i) "Testifying' by Police: A Stubborn Problem.," by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, March 18, 2018; (ii) "New York Detective Charged with Faking

Lineup Results,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, February 17, 2018; (iii) “He Excelled as a Detective, Until Prosecutors Stopped Believing Him,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, October 17, 2017; (iv) “Review Board Notes Rise in New York Police Officers’ False Statement,” by J. David Goodman, *The New York Times*, May 14, 2015; (v) “In Brooklyn Gun Cases, Suspicion Turns to the Police,” by Stephanie Clifford, *The New York Times*, December 11, 2014; (vi) “Detective is Found Guilty of Planting Drugs,” by Tim Stelloh, *The New York Times*, November 1, 2011; and (vii) “The Drugs? They Came From the Police,” by Jim Dwyer, *The New York Times*, October 13, 2011.

55. The NYPD has a longstanding and ignominious record of failing to discipline its officers, or even entertaining allegations of wrongdoing against them. On June 26, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled “2,495 Reports of Police Bias. Not One Was Deemed Valid by the N.Y.P.D.” This article reported that within the last five (5) years, almost 2,500 separate individuals have filed formal complaints with the NYPD alleging that an officer acted with bias toward them, with not a single one being substantiated by the NYPD. Such a finding is plainly incredible and obviously the result of deliberately poor or nonexistent investigatory protocols. The report further impugned the NYPD’s commitment to combat the prejudices and the biases exhibited by many of its officers.

56. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have imposed, tacitly approved or acquiesced to policies, customs, or patterns and practices within the NYPD that resulted in Plaintiff’s arrest without probable cause.

57. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reasonable suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.

58. Defendants' actions, pursuant to Plaintiff's underlying arrest, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of Plaintiff's civil rights that the tacit approval of identical or similar acts by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the rights of any individuals who may come into contact with Defendants, should be inferred, because such flagrant deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and City of New York.

59. Upon information and belief, further details and facts, relating to the unlawful policies, customs or patterns and practices of the NYPD, City of New York and their respective policymakers, supervisors, police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of Defendants, the NYPD and City of New York.

60. Upon information and belief, the personnel files, records and disciplinary histories of the officer Defendants will reveal a history of Constitutional violations indicative of Defendant City's knowledge that the individual officer Defendants were unfit for employment as NYPD officers, or for employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named Defendants committing similar violations in the future was extremely high.

61. Upon information and belief, said personnel files, records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the City and the NYPD were fully aware of Defendants' past

constitutional violations, the unacceptably high probability for the recurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as law enforcement officers, or for employment in general, and that the NYPD and City of New York failed to engage in any preventive or corrective action intended to diminish the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the City's tacit approval of such misconduct or the City's deliberate indifference towards the civil rights of those who may interact with its employees, including VARDZEL.

62. Upon information and belief, the NYPD and City of New York and have failed, or outright refused, to correct the individually named Defendants' predilections to engage in unconstitutional behavior or attempt to prevent the recurrence of such misconduct

63. The aforementioned acts of Defendants, including the City, VARDZEL, YEUNG, GUEVARRA, AMBERSLEY, SOTO and MUNOZ, directly or proximately resulted in the deprivation or violation of Plaintiff's civil rights, as guaranteed and protected by the Fourth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

64. As direct or proximate results of said acts, Plaintiff was caused to suffer the loss of his liberty, irreparable reputational harm, loss of earnings and potential earnings, physical injury, as well as severe and permanent emotional distress, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, traumatization, frustration, extreme inconvenience, and anxiety.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Free Speech Retaliation Claim Under
New York State Law

65. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

66. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities that were protected by Article I, Section 8, of the New York State Constitution.

67. Defendants committed impermissible or unlawful actions against Plaintiff that were motivated or substantially caused by Plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.

68. Defendants' retaliatory actions against Plaintiff resulted in the deprivation of his liberty and the initiation of criminal charges against him.

69. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected Plaintiff's protected speech or activities by physically or procedurally preventing him from further pursuing said protected speech or activities or by chilling his desire to further participate or engage in such protected speech or activities.

70. Accordingly, Plaintiff's right to engage in protected speech and activities, guaranteed and protected by Article I, Section 8, of the New York State Constitution, was violated by Defendants.

71. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings, under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

72. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

First Amendment Retaliation Claim Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

73. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

74. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities that were protected by the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.

75. Defendants committed impermissible or unlawful actions against Plaintiff that were motivated or substantially caused by Plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.

76. Defendants' retaliatory actions against Plaintiff resulted in the deprivation of his liberty and the initiation of criminal charges against him.

77. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected Plaintiff's protected speech or activities by physically or procedurally preventing him from further pursuing said protected speech or activities, or by chilling his desire to further participate or engage in such protected speech or activities.

78. Accordingly, Plaintiff's right to engage in protected speech and activities, as guaranteed and protected by the First Amendment to the United States Constitution, was violated by Defendants.

79. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Search and Seizure Under
New York State Law

80. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

81. Defendants subjected Plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

82. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

83. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

84. The unreasonable searches and seizures to Plaintiff's person and property were not otherwise privileged.

85. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to Article I, Section 12, of the New York State Constitution and Article II, Section 8, of the New York Civil Rights Law.

86. Defendant City of New York, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

87. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search and Seizure Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

88. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

89. Defendants subjected Plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

90. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

91. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

92. The unreasonable searches and seizures to Plaintiff's person and property were not otherwise privileged.

93. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

94. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under
New York State Law

95. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

96. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without a valid warrant or probable cause.

97. Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

98. Plaintiff did not consent to his confinement.

99. Plaintiff's arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.

100. Defendant City of New York, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

101. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

102. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

103. The Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S. Constitution by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff.

104. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.

105. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.

106. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault and Battery Under
New York State Law

107. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

108. At all relevant times, Defendants caused Plaintiff to fear for his physical well-being and safety and placed him in apprehension of immediate harmful and/or offensive touching.

109. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without his consent or justification.

110. Due to the intentional, willful and unlawful acts of Defendants, Plaintiff suffered damages.

111. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

112. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Excessive Force Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

113. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

114. The Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments, because they used unreasonable force without Plaintiff's consent.

115. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without his consent.

116. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution Under
New York State Law

117. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

118. Defendants initiated the prosecution against Plaintiff.

119. Defendants lacked probable cause to believe Plaintiff was guilty or that the prosecution could succeed.

120. Defendants acted with malice, which, in the absence of probable cause, may be inferred.

121. The prosecution was terminated in Plaintiff's favor, when all criminal charges were unconditionally dismissed and sealed.

122. Due to the intentional, willful and unlawful acts of Defendants, Plaintiff suffered significant damages.

123. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

124. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

125. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

126. Defendants initiated the prosecution against Plaintiff.

127. Defendants lacked probable cause to believe Plaintiff was guilty or that the prosecution would succeed.

128. Defendants acted with malice, which, in the absence of probable cause, may be inferred.

129. The prosecution was terminated in Plaintiff's favor, when all criminal charges were unconditionally dismissed and sealed.

130. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment rights.

131. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process Under
New York State Law

132. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

133. Defendants arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated or maintained against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.

134. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain or initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.

135. Defendants intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.

136. Defendants acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.

137. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

138. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Malicious Abuse of Process Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

139. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

140. Defendants arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated or maintained against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.

141. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain and initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.

142. Defendants intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.

143. Defendants acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.

144. Defendants' actions deprived Plaintiff of his constitutional rights to free from illegal searches and seizures and to not be deprived of his liberty without the due process of law in violation of the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

145. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Denial of Right to Fair Trial Under
New York State Law

146. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

147. Defendants fabricated false evidence to be used against Plaintiff that was likely to influence a jury's decision.

148. Defendants forwarded said false information to prosecutors within the District Attorney's Office.

149. Defendants' actions resulted in post-arraignment restrictions and deprivations upon Plaintiff's liberty and freedom of movement.

150. Accordingly, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of his civil rights, pursuant to Article I, Sections 1, 2, 6 & 9, of the New York State Constitution, as well Article II, Sections 10 & 12, of the New York Civil Rights Law.

151. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

152. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Denial of Right to Fair Trial Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

153. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

154. Defendants fabricated false evidence to be used against Plaintiff that was likely to influence a jury's decision.

155. Defendants forwarded said false information to prosecutors within the District Attorney's Office.

156. Defendants' actions resulted in post-arraignment restrictions and deprivations upon Plaintiff's liberty and freedom of movement.

157. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's right to fair trial, pursuant to the Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to United States Constitution.

158. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Biased Based Profiling under
New York City Law

159. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

160. Defendants impermissibly relied upon Plaintiff's actual or perceived race, color, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, gender, religion, religious practice, age, disability or sexual orientation, as the determinative factor in initiating law enforcement action against Plaintiff, rather than Plaintiff's behavior or other information or circumstances that would link Plaintiff to suspected unlawful activity.

161. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to the Administrative Code of the City of New York, Section 14-151

162. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

163. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights and Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws under

New York State law

164. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
165. Plaintiff, as a Hispanic or Latino male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.
166. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color, national origin, ancestry, gender, religion, religious practice, age, disability or sexual orientation
167. Defendants also engaged in the selective treatment of Plaintiff, in comparison to others similarly situated.
168. Defendants' discriminatory treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of his Constitutional rights, or a malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.
169. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.
170. Defendants, motivated by discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.
171. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.
172. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to Article I, Section 11, of the New York State Constitution, Article VII, Section 79-N, of the New York Civil Rights Law and Section 296, Paragraph 13, of the New York Human Rights Law.
173. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
174. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights and Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws under

42 U.S.C. §§ 1981 and 1983 Against Individual Defendants

175. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
176. Plaintiff, as a Hispanic or Latino male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.
177. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color or ethnicity
178. Defendants engaged in the selective treatment of Plaintiff in comparison to others similarly situated.
179. Defendants' selective treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of his Constitutional rights, or malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.
180. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.
181. Defendants, motivated by a discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral penal statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.
182. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.
183. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, under the Fourteenth Amendment.
184. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Conspiracy to Interfere with Civil Rights and Failure to Prevent the Conspiracy under
42 U.S.C. §§ 1983, 1985 and 1986 Against Individual Defendants

185. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
186. Defendants engaged in a conspiracy against Plaintiff to deprive Plaintiff of his rights to engage in protected speech or activities, to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, to be afforded a fair trial, to not be deprived of his liberty or property without due process of law, or of

the privileges and immunities under the laws and constitutions of the United States and of the State of New York.

187. Defendants committed overt acts in furtherance of their conspiracy against Plaintiff.

188. As a result, Plaintiff sustained injuries to his person, was deprived of his liberty or was deprived of rights or privileges of citizens of the United States.

189. Defendants' conspiracy was motivated by a desire to deprive Plaintiff of his civil rights or because of some racial, otherwise class-based, invidious or discriminatory animus.

190. The Defendants that did not engage or participate in the conspiracy to interfere with Plaintiff's civil rights, had knowledge that acts in furtherance of the conspiracy were about to be committed or in process of being committed, possessed the power to prevent or aid in the prevention of the conspiratorial objective, and neglected to do so.

191. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth and/or Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

192. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

NINETEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under New York State Law

193. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

194. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct, observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

195. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

196. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWENTIETH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

197. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

198. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

199. Accordingly, the Defendants who failed to intervene violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.

200. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWENTY-FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Due Process/Fabrication of Evidence Claim Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

201. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

202. Those Defendants deliberately fabricated evidence against the Plaintiff and that as a result of this evidence being used against him, he was deprived of his constitutional right without due process of law.

203. As a result, Plaintiff sustained injuries to his person, was deprived of his liberty or was deprived of rights or privileges of citizens of the United States

204. The Defendants fabricated evidence in order to support their false arrest, detention and prosecution of the Plaintiff. The Defendants used this fabricated evidence and informed the

prosecution that the fabricated evidence was true and accurate despite the fact that knew that the fabricated evidence was not true, As a result, the Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional rights.

205. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWENTY-SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Training, Retention and Supervision Under
New York State Law

206. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

207. Defendant City owed a duty of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, train, retain and supervise its employee Defendants.

208. Defendant City breached those duties of care.

209. Defendant City placed Defendants in a position where they could inflict foreseeable harm.

210. Defendant City knew or reasonably should have known of its employees' propensity for committing civil rights violations.

211. Defendant City failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, training, retaining and supervising its employee Defendants that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.

212. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWENTY-THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Municipal "*Monell*" Liability Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Defendant City

213. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

214. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, tacitly approved of such violative conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as Plaintiff, to such violative behavior.

215. Defendant City's employee police officers have engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of misconduct, so consistent and widespread that it constitutes a custom or usage, of which a supervisor or policymaker must have been aware of.

216. Defendant City, its policymakers and supervisors failed to provide adequate training or supervision to their subordinates, to such an extent that is tantamount to the City's deliberate indifference toward the rights of those who may come into contact with Defendant City's employees.

217. Defendant City's employees engaged in such egregious and flagrant violations of Plaintiff's Constitutional rights that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious and equates to a display of deliberate indifference by Defendant City and its policymakers toward the rights of individuals, who may come into contact with Defendant City's employees.

218. Defendant City's repeated refusal or failure to install or apply corrective or preventive measures constitutes the tacit approval of such violative behavior or a deliberate indifference to the rights of those who may be affected by such behavior.

219. Defendant City's conduct caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, as guaranteed by the Constitution of the United States, via the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth & Fourteenth Amendments thereto.

220. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests judgment against Defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

- a) On the First Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- b) On the Second Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- c) On the Third Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- d) On the Fourth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- e) On the Fifth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- f) On the Sixth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- g) On the Seventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

- h) On the Eighth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- i) On the Ninth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- j) On the Tenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- k) On the Eleventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- l) On the Twelfth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- m) On the Thirteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- n) On the Fourteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

- o) On the Fifteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- p) On the Sixteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- q) On the Seventeenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- r) On the Eighteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- s) On the Nineteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- t) On the Twentieth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- u) On the Twenty-First Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

- v) On the Twenty-Second Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- w) On the Twenty-Third Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- x) Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury on all causes of action set forth herein;
- y) Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorneys' fees and costs, pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and all applicable state or local laws; together with the costs and disbursements of this action.

JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff demands a trial by jury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
April 1, 2021

SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP

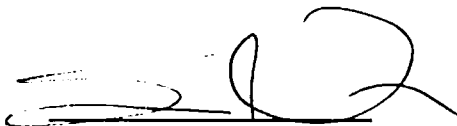


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ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

I, Sameer Nath, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am an associate with the firm of **SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP**, the attorneys of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not by Plaintiff, is because Plaintiff resides outside the county where deponent maintains his office. I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
April 1, 2021



Sameer Nath, Esq.